Rose of Sharon, Althaea

Hibiscus syriacus

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Mirror Garden: 3 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available



Flower
Library candidate

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 8–12 ft (up to 15 ft). Confirmed by standard botanical sources. × 6–10 ft. Confirmed.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 5–8/9. Non-native (Asia). Large deciduous shrub or small multi-stemmed tree. Large summer flowers in many colors. Performs excellently in Atlanta. Prefers full sun and well-drained soil. Attractive for long bloom. Moderate growth. Can be trained as small tree. Drought tolerant once established. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 8–12 ft, full sun to part shade, long bloom, Piedmont performance. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/hibiscus-syriacus/]
Sun: Full sun.
Water: Medium. Prefers well-drained. Drought tolerant once established.
Soil: Well-drained loam preferred. Adaptable. Neutral to alkaline.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun on well-drained soil. Water until established. Suitable as large shrub or small tree. Attractive summer flowers. Minimal pruning (or shape). Good for Atlanta landscapes. Long bloom period.
Soil prep: Well-drained loam preferred. Adaptable. Neutral to alkaline.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Asia. Widely planted.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Large shrub or small multi-stemmed tree. Upright or rounded. Moderate growth. Can be trained.
Foliage: Yellow or none significant.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Gray-brown, developing with age.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Possible aphids, Japanese beetles, leaf spots. Generally durable. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Large summer flowers in many colors. - Can be trained as small tree. - Long bloom. - Drought tolerant. - Attractive form. - Many cultivars.

Sources: - Standard botanical and horticultural references